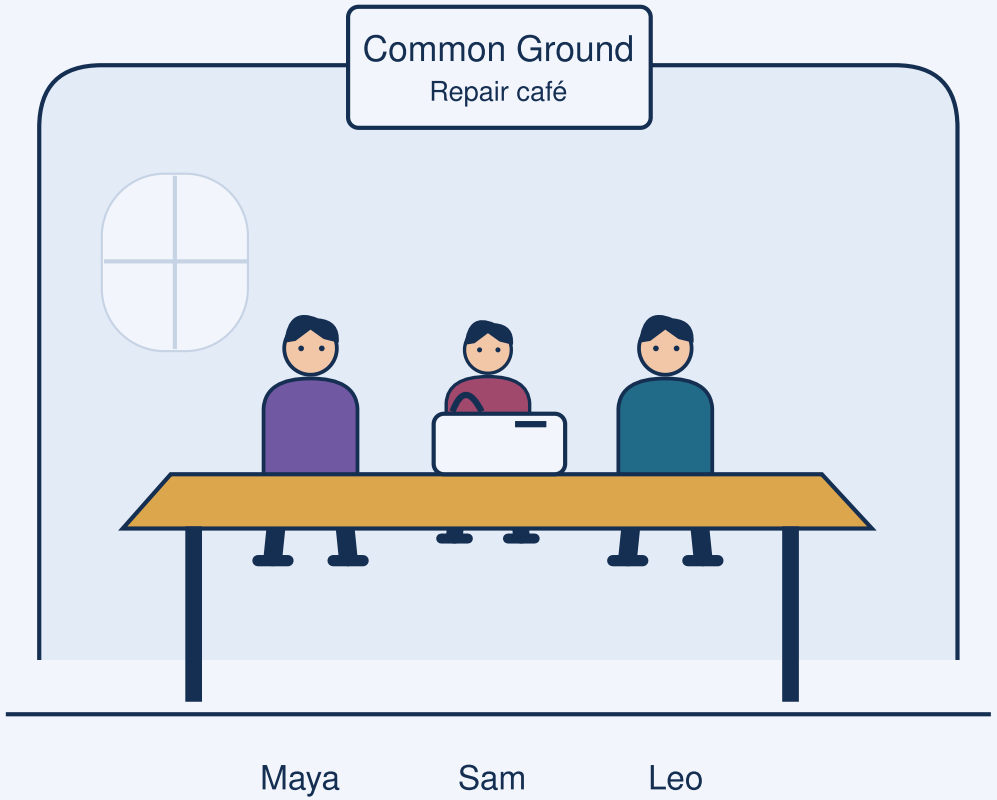
Two invitations. Different reasons to care.

An original story at the Common Ground repair café.



A fictional story. A real question about people.

What would you do?

A prospect worries about time. What helps most?

A A second celebrity endorsement.

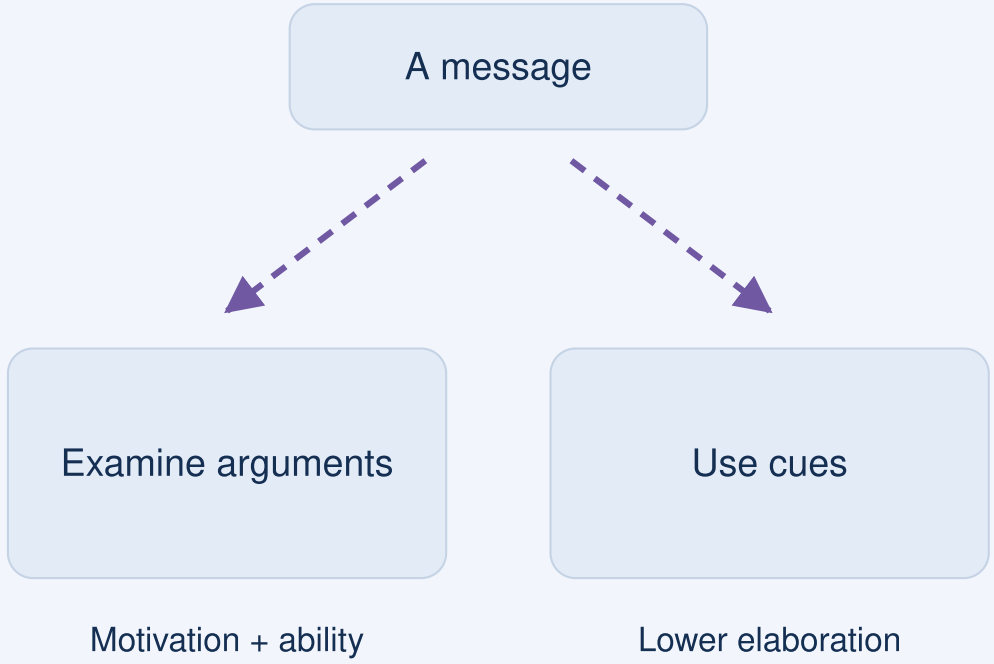
B Shift length, support, and an optional trial.

C A stronger claim that this is unmissable.

Suggested answer: B. Relevant details allow evaluation of the actual commitment.

Attention and evaluation are different jobs.

- Attitude: an evaluation of something.
- Central route: examine relevant arguments.
- Peripheral route: rely more on cues.

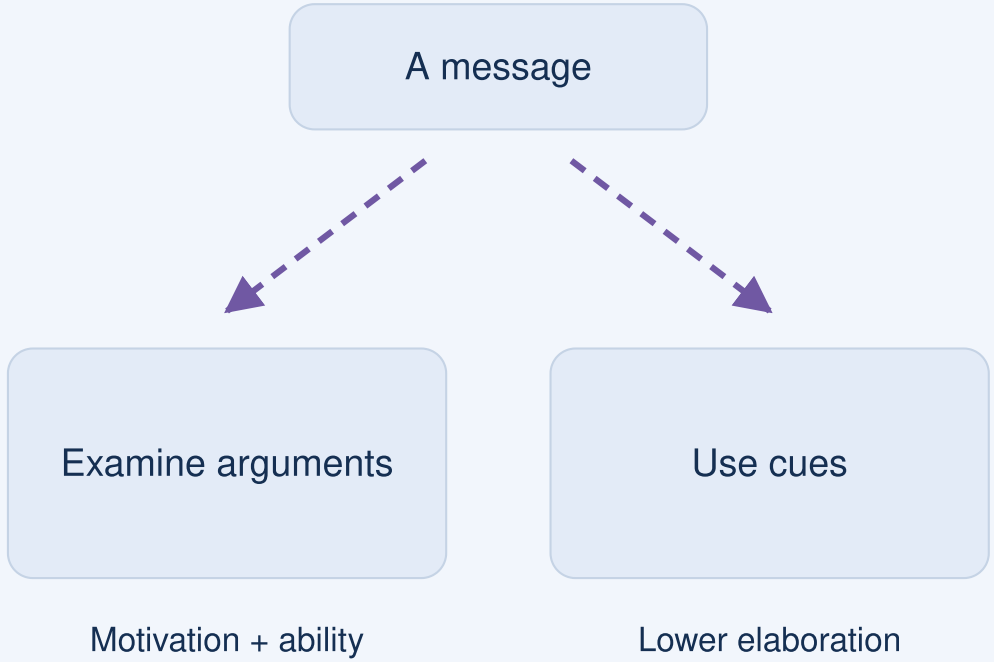


Processing changes with the decision.

Argument evaluation and cue use vary with motivation and ability.

A norm must be true to be useful.

- Descriptive: what people do.
- Injunctive: what people approve.
- A clear request needs an easy next step.

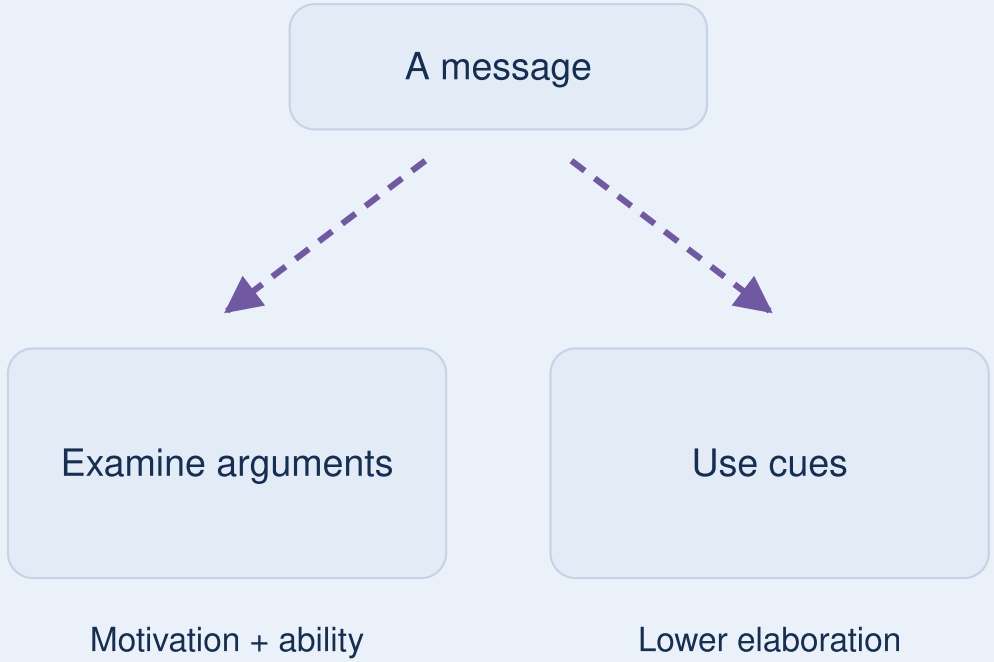


Processing changes with the decision.

Argument evaluation and cue use vary with motivation and ability.

What can we really conclude?

Persuasion varies with audience, topic, source, and outcome. A changed survey answer is not sustained behavior change. These recommendations are design hypotheses to test, not guaranteed conversion techniques. Compare comprehension, informed sign-ups, and retention rather than counting clicks alone. Also ask whether people understood the commitment and felt able to decline it.



Processing changes with the decision.

Conceptual illustration; no research data are plotted.

Try the idea somewhere new.

Few residents currently volunteer. Which invitation is defensible?

A “Everyone here already volunteers.”

B “Hardly anyone helps—don’t be like them.”

C “Try a supported two-hour shift; here is what it involves.”

Suggested answer: C. It gives a concrete, checkable request. Its effect still needs evaluation.

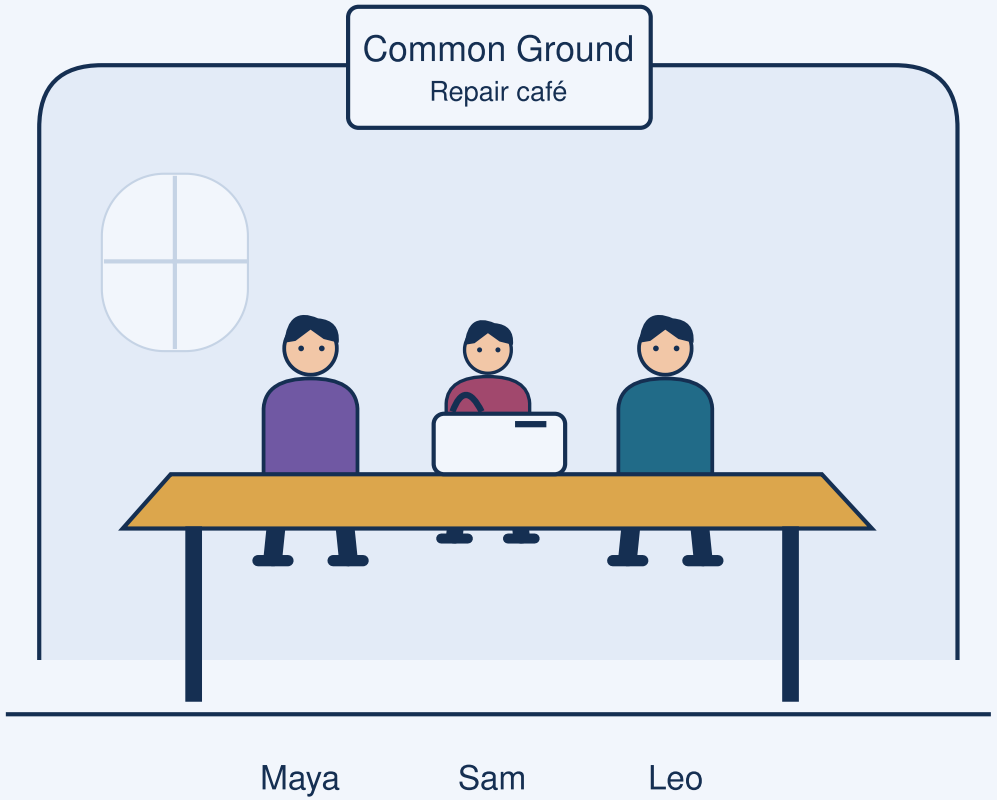
Close your notes. Explain it.

> What makes central processing more likely?

> Distinguish descriptive and injunctive norms.

1. Motivation, ability, attention, and relevant information.

2. Descriptive norms concern actions; injunctive norms concern approval.

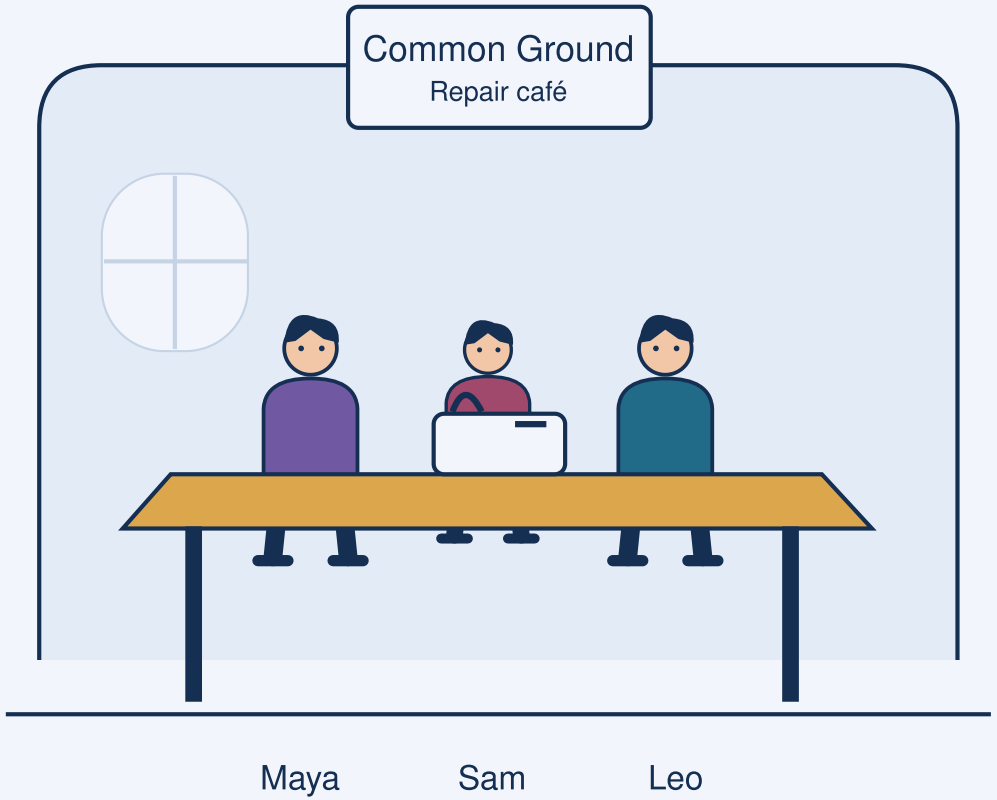


Maya, Sam and Leo at the repair café.

Carry one idea into your week.

Rewrite a low-stakes invitation. State the decision, relevant reason, effort required, and next step. Remove social-proof claims you cannot substantiate.

Revisit tomorrow and in a week.
Explain it without notes, then use a different example.



Take the question into a different setting.